

Enriching continuous Lagrange finite element approximation spaces using neural networks

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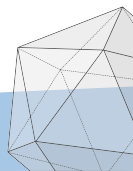
Joint work with:

H. Barucq, F. Faucher, N. Victorion and V. Michel-Dansac.

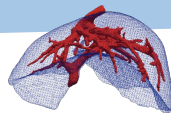
PhD student seminar

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Scientific context



Context : Create real-time digital twins of an organ (e.g. liver).

Objective : Develop an hybrid finite element / neural network method.
accurate quick + parameterized

Parametric elliptic convection/diffusion PDE : For one or several $\mu \in \mathcal{M}$, find $u : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$\mathcal{L}(u; \mathbf{x}, \mu) = f(\mathbf{x}, \mu), \quad (\mathcal{P})$$

where $\mathcal{L}$ is the parametric differential operator defined by

$$\mathcal{L}(\cdot; \mathbf{x}, \mu) : u \mapsto R(\mathbf{x}, \mu)u + C(\mu) \cdot \nabla u - \frac{1}{\text{Pe}} \nabla \cdot (D(\mathbf{x}, \mu) \nabla u),$$

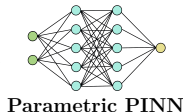
and some Dirichlet, Neumann or Robin BC (which can also depend on μ).

Pipeline of the Enriched FEM

OFFLINE : PINN training

Inputs

$\mathbf{x} \in \Omega$: space coordinates
 $\boldsymbol{\mu} \in \mathcal{M}$: parameter



Output

$u_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu})$: prediction of
 the PDE solution $u(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu})$

ONLINE (fixed $\boldsymbol{\mu}$) : PINN evaluation + Enriched FEM resolution

PINN evaluation

$u_\theta(\cdot, \boldsymbol{\mu})$: prediction for
 the given parameter $\boldsymbol{\mu}$



FEM solver
 enriched by u_θ



Output

enriched FEM solution
 (depending on the mesh size h)

Complete ONLINE process : quick + accurate

Classical approaches

Physics-Informed Neural Networks

Standard PINNs¹ (Weak BC) : Find the optimal weights θ^* , such that

$$\theta^* = \underset{\theta}{\operatorname{argmin}} \left(\omega_r J_r(\theta) + \omega_b J_b(\theta) \right), \quad (\mathcal{P}_\theta)$$

with

residual loss

$$J_r(\theta) = \int_{\mathcal{M}} \int_{\Omega} |\mathcal{L}(u_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}); \mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) - f(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu})|^2 d\mathbf{x} d\boldsymbol{\mu},$$

boundary loss

$$J_b(\theta) = \int_{\mathcal{M}} \int_{\partial\Omega} |u_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) - g(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu})|^2 d\mathbf{x} d\boldsymbol{\mu},$$

where u_θ is a neural network, $g = 0$ is the Dirichlet BC.

In $(\mathcal{P}_\theta)$, ω_r and ω_b are some weights.

Monte-Carlo method : Discretize the cost functions by random process.

¹[Raissi et al., 2019]

Physics-Informed Neural Networks

Improved PINNs¹ (Strong BC) : Find the optimal weights θ^* such that

$$\theta^* = \underset{\theta}{\operatorname{argmin}} \left(\omega_r J_r(\theta) + \cancel{\omega_b J_b(\theta)} \right),$$

with $\omega_r = 1$ and

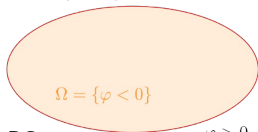
residual loss

$$J_r(\theta) = \int_{\mathcal{M}} \int_{\Omega} |\mathcal{L}(u_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}); \mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) - f(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu})|^2 d\mathbf{x} d\boldsymbol{\mu},$$

$$\partial\Omega = \{\varphi = 0\}$$

where u_{θ} is a neural network defined by

$$u_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) = \varphi(\mathbf{x}) w_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) + g(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}),$$



with φ a level-set function, w_{θ} a NN and $g = 0$ the Dirichlet BC.

Thus, the Dirichlet BC is imposed exactly in the PINN : $u_{\theta} = g$ on $\partial\Omega$.

¹[Lagaris et al., 1998; Franck et al., 2024]

Finite Element Method¹

Variational Problem :

$$\text{Find } u_h \in V_h^0 \text{ such that, } \forall v_h \in V_h^0, a(u_h, v_h) = l(v_h), \quad (\mathcal{P}_h)$$

with h the characteristic mesh size, a and l the bilinear and linear forms given by

$$a(u_h, v_h) = \frac{1}{\text{Pe}} \int_{\Omega} D \nabla u_h \cdot \nabla v_h + \int_{\Omega} R u_h v_h + \int_{\Omega} v_h C \cdot \nabla u_h, \quad l(v_h) = \int_{\Omega} f v_h,$$

and V_h^0 the finite element space defined by

$$V_h^0 = \{v_h \in C^0(\Omega), \forall K \in \mathcal{T}_h, v_h|_K \in \mathbb{P}_k, v_h|_{\partial\Omega} = 0\},$$

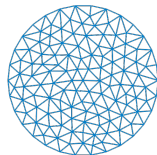
where $\mathbb{P}_k$ is the space of polynomials of degree at most k .

Linear system : Let $(\phi_1, \dots, \phi_{N_h})$ a basis of V_h^0 .

Find $U \in \mathbb{R}^{N_h}$ such that $AU = b$

with

$$A = (a(\phi_i, \phi_j))_{1 \leq i, j \leq N_h} \quad \text{and} \quad b = (l(\phi_j))_{1 \leq j \leq N_h}.$$



$$\mathcal{T}_h = \{K_1, \dots, K_{N_e}\}$$

(N_e : number of elements)

¹[Ern and Guermond, 2004]

Enriched finite element method using PINN

Additive approach

Variational Problem : Let $u_\theta \in H^{k+1}(\Omega) \cap H_0^1(\Omega)$ be a PINN prior.

$$\text{Find } p_h^+ \in V_h^0 \text{ such that, } \forall v_h \in V_h^0, a(p_h^+, v_h) = l(v_h) - a(u_\theta, v_h), \quad (\mathcal{P}_h^+)$$

with the **enriched trial space** V_h^+ defined by

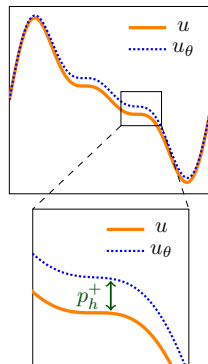
$$V_h^+ = \{u_h^+ = u_\theta + p_h^+, \quad p_h^+ \in V_h^0\}.$$

General Dirichlet BC : If $u = g$ on $\partial\Omega$, then

$$p_h^+ = g - u_\theta \quad \text{on } \partial\Omega,$$

with u_θ the PINN prior.

We hope that the modified problem will give the same results as the standard one on coarser meshes.



Convergence analysis

Theorem 1: Convergence analysis of the standard FEM [Ern and Guermond, 2004]

We denote $u_h \in V_h$ the solution of $(\mathcal{P}_h)$ with V_h the standard trial space. Then,

$$|u - u_h|_{H^1} \leq C_{H^1} h^k |u|_{H^{k+1}},$$

$$\|u - u_h\|_{L^2} \leq C_{L^2} h^{k+1} |u|_{H^{k+1}}.$$

Theorem 2: Convergence analysis of the enriched FEM [Lecourtier et al., 2025]

We denote $u_h^+ \in V_h^+$ the solution of $(\mathcal{P}_h^+)$ with V_h^+ the enriched trial space. Then,

$$|u - u_h^+|_{H^1} \leq \frac{|u - u_\theta|_{H^{k+1}}}{|u|_{H^{k+1}}} (C_{H^1} h^k |u|_{H^{k+1}}),$$

$$\|u - u_h^+\|_{L^2} \leq \frac{|u - u_\theta|_{H^{k+1}}}{|u|_{H^{k+1}}} (C_{L^2} h^{k+1} |u|_{H^{k+1}}).$$

Gains of the additive approach.

LECOURTIER Frédérique

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Problem considered

Problem statement: Consider the Poisson problem in 2D with Dirichlet BC:

$$\begin{cases} -\Delta u = f, & \text{in } \Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \\ u = 0, & \text{on } \partial\Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \end{cases}$$

with $\Omega = [-0.5\pi, 0.5\pi]^2$ and $\mathcal{M} = [-0.5, 0.5]^2$ ($p = 2$ parameters).

Analytical solution :

$$u(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) = \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu_1)^2 + (y - \mu_2)^2}{2}\right) \sin(2x) \sin(2y).$$

PINN training:

MLP 5 layers (sine - 40, 60, 60, 60, 40); LBFGs optimizer (5000 epochs - 6000 col. pts).

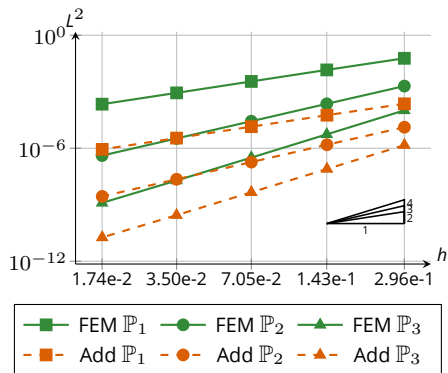
Imposing the Dirichlet BC exactly in the PINN with the levelset φ defined by

$$\varphi(\mathbf{x}) = (x + 0.5\pi)(x - 0.5\pi)(y + 0.5\pi)(y - 0.5\pi).$$

Online phase - 1 set of parameters

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22)$$

Error estimates in L^2 norm:

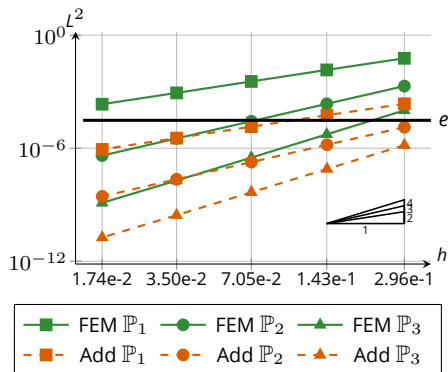


Online phase - 1 set of parameters

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22)$$

Error estimates in L^2 norm:

N_{dofs} required to reach the same error e :



k	e	N_{dofs}	
		FEM	Add
1	$1 \cdot 10^{-3}$	14 161	64
	$1 \cdot 10^{-4}$	143 641	576
2	$1 \cdot 10^{-4}$	6 889	225
	$1 \cdot 10^{-5}$	31 329	1 089
3	$1 \cdot 10^{-5}$	6 724	784
	$1 \cdot 10^{-6}$	20 164	2 704

Parametric framework

Considering the set of $n_p = 50$ parameter instances

$$\mathcal{S} = \left\{ \boldsymbol{\mu}^{(1)}, \dots, \boldsymbol{\mu}^{(n_p)} \right\}.$$

Gains achieved: $\|u - u_h\|_{L^2} / \|u - u_h^+\|_{L^2}$

Gains in L^2 rel error of our method w.r.t. FEM			
k	min	max	mean
1	134.32	377.36	269.39
2	67.02	164.65	134.85
3	39.52	72.65	61.55

Cartesian mesh : N^2 nodes with $N = 20$.

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Problem considered

Problem statement: Consider the Poisson problem in 3D with Dirichlet BC:

$$\begin{cases} -\Delta u = f, & \text{in } \Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \\ u = 0, & \text{on } \partial\Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \end{cases}$$

with $\Omega = [-0.5\pi, 0.5\pi]^3$ and $\mathcal{M} = [-0.5, 0.5]^3$ ($p = 3$ parameters).

Analytical solution :

$$u(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\mu}) = \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu_1)^2 + (y - \mu_2)^2 + (z - \mu_3)^2}{2}\right) \sin(2x) \sin(2y) \sin(2z).$$

PINN training:

MLP 5 layers (tanh - 40, 60, 60, 60, 40); LBFGs optimizer (5000 epochs - 40000 col. pts).

Imposing the Dirichlet BC exactly in the PINN with the levelset φ defined by

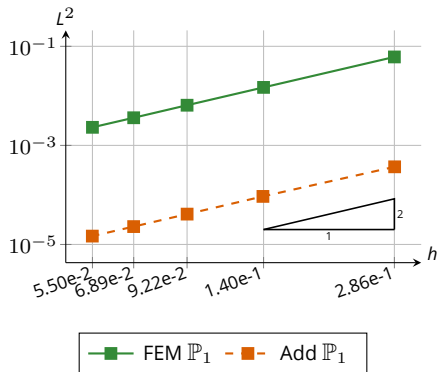
$$\varphi(\mathbf{x}) = (x + 0.5\pi)(x - 0.5\pi)(y + 0.5\pi)(y - 0.5\pi)(z + 0.5\pi)(z - 0.5\pi).$$

Training time : 12 minutes on NVIDIA RTX 2000 (8GB VRAM).

Online phase - 1 parameters instance I

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22, 0.1)$$

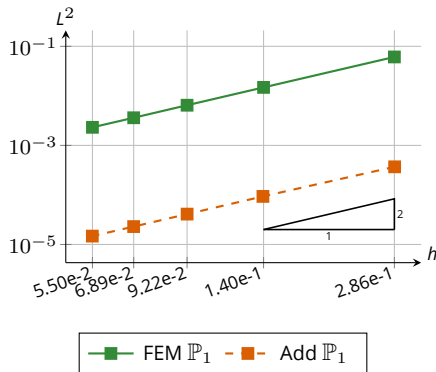
Error estimates in L^2 norm:



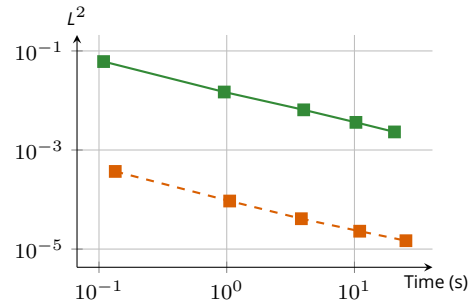
Online phase - 1 parameters instance I

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22, 0.1)$$

Error estimates in L^2 norm:



L^2 error w.r.t. execution time*:



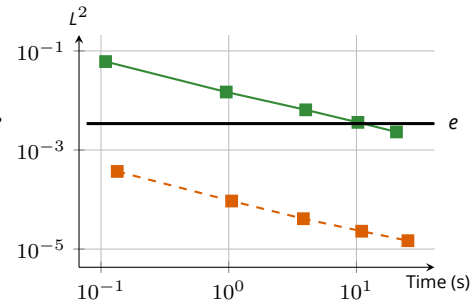
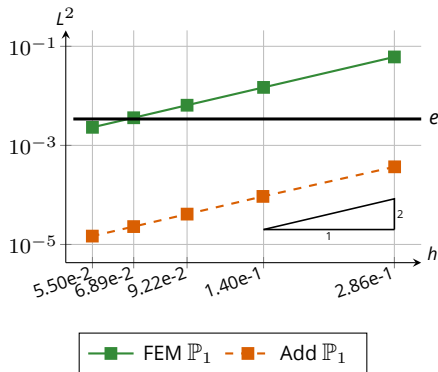
* mesh + assembly + solve
 + prior derivatives evaluation
 + training time

Online phase - 1 parameters instance I

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22, 0.1)$$

Error estimates in L^2 norm:

L^2 error w.r.t. execution time*:



* mesh + assembly + solve
 + prior derivatives evaluation
 + training time

Online phase - 1 parameters instance II

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.05, 0.22, 0.1)$$

N_{dofs} and computation time required to reach the same error e :

e	N		N_{dofs}		Computation time*	
	FEM	Add	FEM	Add	FEM	Add
$1 \cdot 10^{-3}$	152	12	$3.51 \cdot 10^6$	$1.73 \cdot 10^3$	$(7.65 \cdot 10^1)$	$5.2 \cdot 10^{-2}$
$1 \cdot 10^{-4}$	484	39	$1.13 \cdot 10^8$	$5.93 \cdot 10^4$	$(2.8 \cdot 10^3)$	$9.26 \cdot 10^{-1}$
$1 \cdot 10^{-5}$	1539	122	$3.65 \cdot 10^9$	$1.82 \cdot 10^6$	$(1.02 \cdot 10^5)$	$(5.26 \cdot 10^1)$

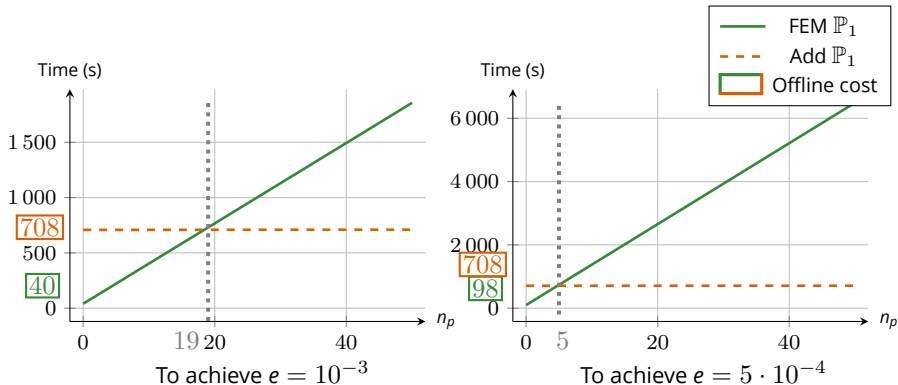
— $\div 1471$ —→

Cartesian mesh : N^3 nodes; $\mathbb{P}_1$ elements.

* The results in brackets are extrapolations.

Parametric framework

How many parameters instance n_p are needed to balance training?



Online: assembly + solve + prior derivatives evaluation

Offline: mesh + training time

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Problem considered

Problem statement: Considering an Anisotropic Elliptic problem with Dirichlet BC:

$$\begin{cases} -\operatorname{div}(D\nabla u) = f, & \text{in } \Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \\ u = 0, & \text{on } \partial\Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \end{cases}$$

with $\Omega = [0, 1]^2$ and $\mathcal{M} = [0.4, 0.6]^2 \times [0.01, 1] \times [0.1, 0.8]$ ($p = 4$ parameters).

Right-hand side and diffusion matrix: $\mu = (\mu_1, \mu_2, \sigma, \epsilon) \in \mathcal{M}$

$$f(\mathbf{x}, \mu) = \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu_1)^2 + (y - \mu_2)^2}{0.025\sigma^2}\right).$$

$$D(\mathbf{x}, \mu) = \begin{pmatrix} \epsilon x^2 + y^2 & (\epsilon - 1)xy \\ (\epsilon - 1)xy & x^2 + \epsilon y^2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

PINN training: MLP with Fourier Features¹ of 5 layers (tanh - 40, 60, 60, 60, 40).

Adam optimizer (15000 epochs - 8000 col. pts).

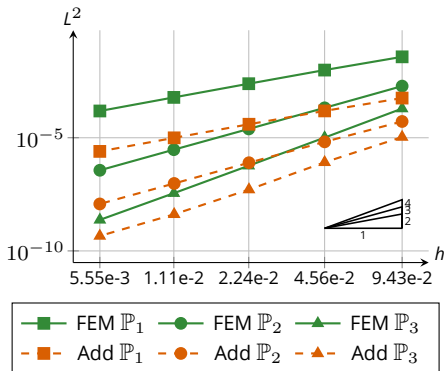
Imposing the Dirichlet BC exactly in the PINN with the a level-set function.

¹[Tancik et al., 2020]

Online phase

Error estimates : 1 parameters instance.

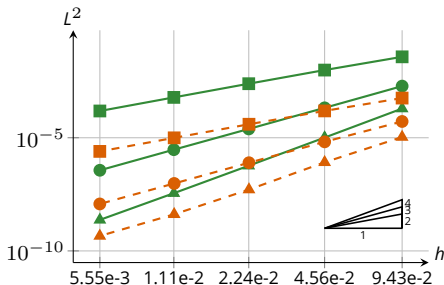
$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.51, 0.54, 0.52, 0.55)$$



Online phase

Error estimates : 1 parameters instance.

$$\mu^{(1)} = (0.51, 0.54, 0.52, 0.55)$$



Gains achieved : $\|u - u_h\|_{L^2} / \|u - u_h^+\|_{L^2}$

Considering $n_p = 50$ parameter instances

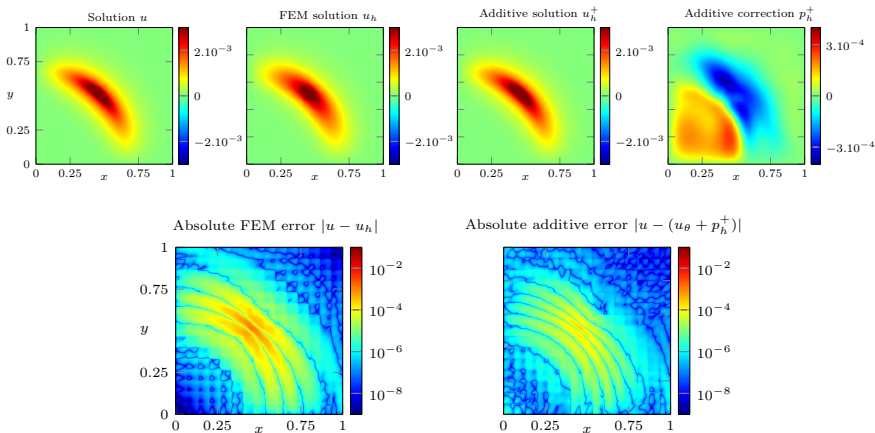
$$\mathcal{S} = \left\{ \mu^{(1)}, \dots, \mu^{(n_p)} \right\}.$$

**Gains in L^2 rel error
of our method w.r.t. FEM**

k	min	max	mean
1	7.12	82.57	35.67
2	3.54	35.88	18.32
3	1.33	26.51	8.32

Cartesian mesh : N^2 nodes with $N = 20$.

Numerical solutions and errors



$$\mu^{(2)} = (0.46, 0.52, 0.05, 0.12) \quad (k = 2, N = 16)$$

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Problem considered

Problem statement: Considering the Poisson problem with mixed BC:

$$\begin{cases} -\Delta u = f, & \text{in } \Omega \times \mathcal{M}, \\ u = g, & \text{on } \Gamma_E \times \mathcal{M}, \\ \frac{\partial u}{\partial n} + u = g_R, & \text{on } \Gamma_I \times \mathcal{M}, \end{cases}$$

with $\Omega = \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2, 0.25 \leq x^2 + y^2 \leq 1\}$ and $\mathcal{M} = [2.4, 2.6]$ ($p = 1$ parameter).

Analytical solution and boundary conditions:

$$u(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = 1 - \frac{\ln(\mu_1 \sqrt{x^2 + y^2})}{\ln(4)},$$

$$g(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = 1 - \frac{\ln(\mu_1)}{\ln(4)} \quad \text{and} \quad g_R(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = 2 + \frac{4 - \ln(\mu_1)}{\ln(4)}.$$

PINN training:

MLP 5 layers (tanh - 5×40); LBFGs optimizer (4000 epochs - 6000 col. pts).

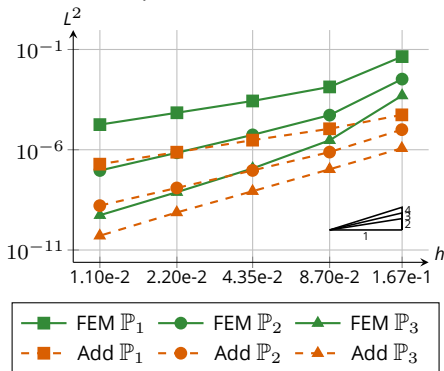
Imposing the mixed BC exactly in the PINN¹ (+ Sobolev training).

¹[Sukumar and Srivastava, 2022]

Online phase

Error estimates : 1 parameters instance.

$$\mu^{(1)} = 2.51$$



Gains achieved : $\|u - u_h\|_{L^2} / \|u - u_h^+\|_{L^2}$

Considering $n_p = 50$ parameter instances

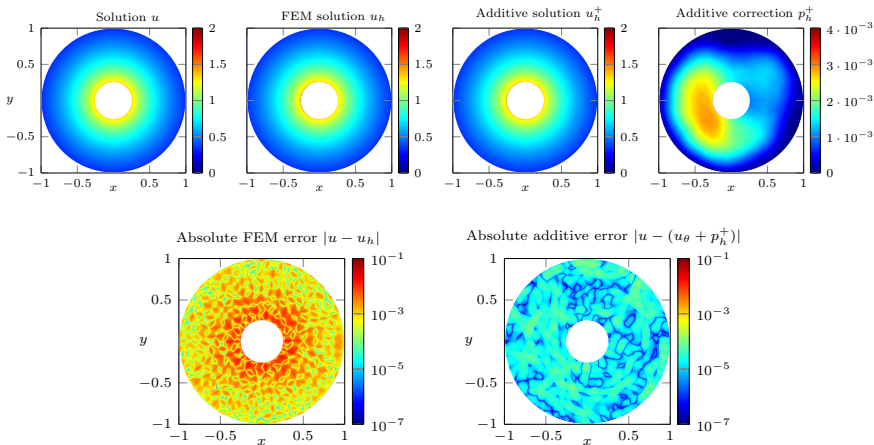
$$\mathcal{S} = \left\{ \mu^{(1)}, \dots, \mu^{(n_p)} \right\}.$$

**Gains in L^2 rel error
of our method w.r.t. FEM**

k	min	max	mean
1	15.12	137.72	55.5
2	31	77.46	58.41
3	18.72	21.49	20.6

Mesh size: $h = 1.33 \cdot 10^{-1}$

Numerical solutions and errors



$$\mu^{(1)} = 2.51 \quad (k = 1, h = 1.67 \cdot 10^{-1})$$

Numerical results

2D Poisson problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

3D Poisson problem on Cube - Dirichlet BC

2D Anisotropic Elliptic problem on Square - Dirichlet BC

2D Poisson problem on Annulus - Mixed BC

1D non-smooth transmission problem - Dirichlet BC

Problem considered

TODO

Conclusion

TODO

Preprint (linear)



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Preprint (linear)





Appendix 1 : Sec1



A1 – Appendix 1

TODO